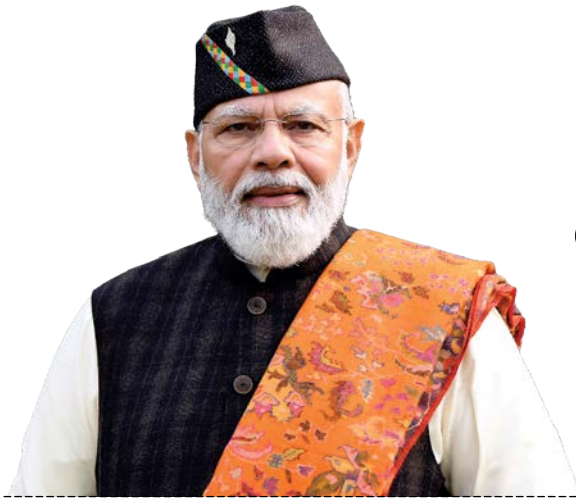


> The construction of a developed India for the twenty-first century is based primarily on two pillars. First, pride in our heritage, and second, all possible efforts for development. Today, Uttarakhand is strengthening both these pillars. In such a situation, it would be logical to say that this decade will undoubtedly be the decade of Uttarakhand.
>
> ***– Narendra Modi, Prime Minister***

FORGING A PATH TO PROGRESS: UTTARAKHAND'S DYNAMIC POLICIES IGNITE INDUSTRIAL GROWTH AND EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITIES

The development of any state rests on those practical policies that make it easy to fulfill all the needs that are necessary for progress. Under the leadership of Pushkar Singh Dhami, the government of Uttarakhand has fostered an environment of rapid development through such policies. With the aim of bolstering investments, increasing employment opportunities, and ensuring holistic growth in 'Devbhoomi Uttarakhand,' the state government has introduced a fresh array of initiatives, including a new industrial policy, the Chief Minister Employment Scheme, the Uttarakhand Logistics Policy, the Startup Policy, and the MSME Policy-2023. The commitment, dedication, and persistent efforts toward continuous progress are evident in the functioning of the Dhami-led government in Uttarakhand. To strengthen the state's industrial environment, the state government is launching a slew of initiatives that will prove to be milestones in the development of Uttarakhand in the future.

On August 3, the Cabinet, presided over by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, approved the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) Policy-2023. Until now, the MSME Policy-2015 was in effect in the state (with amendments made from time to time). Because its validity was coming to an end, the Department of Industries formulated a fresh MSME policy, encompassing pivotal components of industrial growth within the state.

In the policy, the subsidy has been increased the most in the hills. The subsidy will be less in the plains, which means setting up industry in the mountain will be beneficial. This will provide employment opportunities by setting up new industries in the mountains. There will be a ban on migration as well. Subsidies ranging from Rs 20 lakh to Rs 4 crore will now be provided for the establishment of micro, medium, and small-scale industries in the state's hilly districts. A 10% additional subsidy will be provided for the establishment of a local level raw material industry.



Instead of five, MSMEs are now divided into four categories in the new MSME policy: Category A, Category B, Category C, and Category D. Those districts that are completely mountainous and have the highest elevation have been kept in "A Category." In the "B-category" there are such mountainous districts that are relatively less accessible. Plain districts have been included in the “C Category” and “D Category”. The 2015 policy also had an additional B+ category. A hundred percent reimbursement of stamp duty will be given for setting up new industries in A and B category areas. While 75 percent will be reimbursed in the C category and 50 percent in the D category. Rs One crore has been fixed for capital investment in microindustries, Rs 1 to 5 crores for small-scale industries, and Rs 10 to 50 crores for medium industries.

To promote ZED certification, the policy includes the provision of cash rewards. Industries achieving gold certification will receive a prize of 75 thousand rupees, while silver-certified industries will be granted 50 thousand rupees, and those with bronze certification will be